2級レベル　オリジナル長文読解

L01 When the Office Comes Home ｜ 生徒用・校内試行版

Goal：①論の展開を追う　②パラフレーズで根拠を照合　③筆者の含意を推論　④主題を1文で　｜　55〜60分

Step 1 Warm-up ｜読む前に考えよう（5分）

Q1. Would you like to work from home or in an office? Why?

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Q2. What problems do small towns in Japan face today?

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Step 2 Vocabulary Preview ｜重要語句（8分）

Word / Phrase	品詞	日本語	本文中の例
concentrate	動	集中する／させる	the best jobs were concentrated
reverse	動	逆転させる	reverse this long trend
productivity	名	生産性	productivity did not fall
commute	名	通勤	without the daily commute
opportunity	名	好機	some small towns saw an opportunity
convince	動	納得させる	convince them to stay
novelty	名	目新しさ	once the novelty wears off
tension	名	緊張・あつれき	tension sometimes appeared
take ~ for granted	句	～を当然と思う	services they had taken for granted
destined to	句	～する運命の	towns destined to fade away

Prediction：タイトル「When the Office Comes Home」から、どんな話だと思いますか。

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Step 3　Reading ｜論の流れを追って読む（16 分）

When the Office Comes Home

[1] For decades, the path to a successful career in Japan seemed to run in one direction: toward the city. Young people left small towns for Tokyo and Osaka, where the best jobs were concentrated. As a result, rural areas lost population year after year, and many local communities struggled to survive. Few people imagined that a change in the way people work could begin to reverse this long trend.

[2] That change arrived faster than anyone expected. When companies were suddenly forced to let employees work from home, many discovered that productivity did not fall. In fact, some tasks were completed more efficiently without the daily commute. Once workers realized that they no longer needed to live near the office, a question naturally followed: why pay high rent in a crowded city when the same job could be done from a quieter, cheaper place?

[3] Some small towns saw an opportunity. Rather than waiting for newcomers to appear, they took action. A town in Nagano, for example, turned an empty school building into a shared workspace with fast internet and offered new residents help with housing costs. The plan was not simply to attract workers but to convince them to stay. Local officials understood that a town gains little if people move in for a year and then leave once the novelty wears off.

[4] The results have been mixed. In some places, the arrival of remote workers brought fresh energy: cafés reopened, and children's voices returned to schools that had nearly closed. Yet tension sometimes appeared as well. Long-time residents occasionally felt that newcomers did not respect local customs, while the newcomers complained that services they had taken for granted in the city were hard to find. Building a community, it turned out, required more than a fast internet connection.

[5] Still, the experiment has changed how many people think about where they can live well. The office is no longer a fixed place that determines where a person must settle. For towns that once seemed destined to fade away, this shift offers something they had lacked for a long time: a reason for hope, and a chance to write a different ending.

Reading strategy：各段落の役割（背景→きっかけ→対応→課題→展望）を意識し、but / yet / still の前後で論が転じる点に印を付けよう。

Gist Check：この文章の主張を、日本語で 1 文にまとめよう。

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Step 4 Comprehension ｜根拠と含意を読む（20 分）

1. According to the first paragraph, why did rural areas lose population for so long?

A. Because local communities refused to accept young newcomers.
B. Because the best jobs were concentrated in large cities.
C. Because the government encouraged families to move to Tokyo.
D. Because rural schools were unable to teach modern skills.

2. What did many companies discover when employees worked from home?

A. That most workers preferred to return to the office quickly.
B. That productivity did not fall, and some tasks were done more efficiently.
C. That working from home was only possible in large cities.
D. That employees needed more training to use the internet.

3. Why did the town in Nagano offer help with housing costs?

A. To replace the old school building with new apartments.
B. To attract remote workers and persuade them to settle permanently.
C. To reduce the rent paid by long-time local residents.
D. To compete with companies that wanted to build offices there.

4. The phrase "once the novelty wears off" in paragraph 3 suggests that

A. newcomers may lose interest after the excitement of moving fades.
B. towns should keep their plans secret from outsiders.
C. remote work becomes more popular as time passes.
D. housing costs rise sharply after the first year.

5. Which statement best describes the "mixed" results mentioned in paragraph 4?

A. Remote work failed in every town that tried it.
B. Newcomers and long-time residents always cooperated smoothly.
C. Some towns gained new energy, but social tension also appeared.
D. Local services improved faster than anyone had expected.

6. What does the writer mean by "a chance to write a different ending" in the last paragraph?

A. An opportunity for declining towns to avoid disappearing.
B. A plan to rebuild every empty school in the countryside.
C. A method for companies to lower their office costs.
D. A way for cities to stop people from moving away.

7. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Remote work has completely solved the problems of rural Japan.
B. A shift in how people work has opened new possibilities, though challenges remain.
C. Cities will soon lose all of their workers to small towns.
D. Fast internet is the only thing rural towns need to grow.

Step 5 Organize & Respond ｜整理して使おう（11 分）

A. Match each paragraph with its role.（各段落の役割を線で結ぼう）

[1] ・　　・ きっかけ（働き方の変化）

[2] ・　　・ 背景（都市集中と過疎）

[3] ・　　・ 残る課題（あつれき）

[4] ・　　・ 町の対応（移住者の定着策）

[5] ・　　・ 展望（希望と新しい結末）

B. Complete the summary.（Word Bank から選ぼう）

Word Bank：commute / settle / tension / hope

When people could work from home, the daily (①　　) became unnecessary, and some moved to cheaper towns. To make newcomers (②　　) for good, towns offered support. Results were mixed: fresh energy appeared, but social (③　　) did too. Even so, the change gave fading towns new (④).

C. Your Response：Do you think remote work will help rural towns in the long run? Why? （3〜4 文）

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Self-check　□論の展開　□but/yet の転換　□パラフレーズ照合　□含意を推論　□主題 1 文　□意見 3 文